128 Claude answers to 64 buyer questions in 5 EU niches: who gets linked

We asked Claude 64 questions a buyer would ask about beauty and collagen supplements, food supplements, loose-leaf tea, mattresses and specialty coffee in Belgium, France and Ireland, twice each. Runs: 2026-10-18 to 2026-10-19. Assistant tested: Claude, web search on, no history. One assistant only.

FINDINGS

- The most-linked shop appears in 19% to 56% of a cell's answers; the top three shops take 17% to 32% of shop links.
- Two runs of the same question share only 32% to 77% of the shop sites they link, on average per cell.
- Links go to shops' own sites: 466 of 652 links.
- Claude linked 4 domains with no working page, 4 times in total, in 3 of 8 cells.

METHOD AND LIMITS

A shop counts as linked when its domain is among the answer's links; names in running text are not counted. Every answer is stored with a timestamp. One assistant (Claude, web search on), 128 answers: read percentages as counts, not market share. These answers differ from what a signed-in person sees, and other assistants may link different shops. Domains are as Claude linked them; we checked which ones load on 18 Oct 2026. No causes are claimed. Licence: CC BY 4.0, credit CitedBy with a link.

DATA

Tables per niche and country, method and CSV downloads: citedby.eu/data. Contact: hello@citedby.eu.